

BUILD LOCAL APPS WITH AI ASSISTANCE

A Complete Guide for Non-Technical Users

Create Single-Executable Desktop Applications

No Prior Coding Experience Required



WHO IS THIS FOR?

Non-Technical People

Little or no programming experience
who want to create tools



Small Business Owners

Need simple custom tools without hiring
developers



Teachers & Students

Want to automate tasks and learn
through building



Idea People

Have app ideas but don't know where to
start coding



You describe WHAT you want. The AI writes HOW to make it. You package it into a single file.

THE BIG PICTURE — 6 SIMPLE STEPS



WHAT YOU NEED BEFORE STARTING

All free — takes just a few minutes to set up



Python 3.13+

The programming language
your app will use

python.org/downloads



Text Editor

Where you paste and
save AI-generated code

[VS Code \(free\)](#)



AI Assistant

Writes the code for
you in plain English

[ChatGPT / Claude / Gemini](#)



PyInstaller

Turns your script into
a single .exe file

[pip install pyinstaller](#)



When installing Python, always check “Add Python to PATH” — this is critical!

RECOMMENDED TECHNOLOGY STACK

Component	Tool	Why
Language	Python	Easiest for AI to generate; huge library support
UI Framework	tkinter (built-in)	Included with Python; no extra install
Modern UI	Flet (optional)	Beautiful Flutter-based interfaces
Packaging	PyInstaller	One command to create a single .exe
Data Storage	SQLite / JSON	Built into Python; everything stays local

WHY PYTHON + TKINTER?

- ✓ Built-in with Python — zero extra setup
- ✓ AI assistants excel at generating this code
- ✓ Works on Windows, macOS, and Linux

WANT A MODERN LOOK?

Try Flet — creates Flutter-based UIs

Install: `pip install flet`

Also packages with PyInstaller!

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DESCRIBE YOUR APP IDEA

THE PROMPT FORMULA

I want to build a desktop app that
[MAIN PURPOSE].

The app should:

- [Feature 1]
- [Feature 2]
- [Feature 3]

Technical requirements:

- Python with tkinter
- Store data in SQLite
- Must work offline
- Single .py file
- PyInstaller compatible

KEY TIPS



Be Specific

Instead of “make a tracker”, say what data fields and features you need



Include Requirements

Always specify Python, tkinter, single file, SQLite, PyInstaller



Think Like a User

Describe what the app looks and feels like to someone using it



Iterate!

Your first version won't be perfect. Refine by telling AI what to change

2

AI GENERATES CODE

- 1. Send your prompt to the AI
- 2. AI responds with Python code
- 3. Copy ALL the code
- 4. Paste into a new file
- 5. Save as `my_app.py`

3

TEST YOUR APP

```
> cd C:\MyApps\my_project  
> python my_app.py
```

Your app window appears!
Try it out and note anything to fix.

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

I ran the code and got this error:
[paste the error message here]

Please fix and give me the COMPLETE updated code.

4

PACKAGE INTO A SINGLE FILE

THE MAGIC COMMAND

```
pyinstaller --onefile --windowed my_app.py
```

--onefile

Bundle everything into a single .exe file

--windowed

Hide the black console window (GUI apps)

--icon=x.ico

Add a custom icon to your .exe

--name=MyApp

Set a custom name for the output file

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SHARE YOUR APP

USB drive • Email (zip it) • Cloud storage • Local network

Your .exe will be in the dist/ folder inside your project directory

PROMPT TEMPLATES – COPY & CUSTOMIZE



Data Entry / Records

Track inventory, contacts, records with search & export

```
"Build a Python app for tracking inventory with fields: name, quantity, price, category. Add, edit, delete, filter, export to CSV."
```



File Processing

Batch rename, convert, or organize files automatically

```
"Build an app that lets me select a folder and batch rename files with date prefixes. Show progress and a log of changes."
```



Calculator / Converter

Custom calculations, unit conversions, business formulas

```
"Build a tip calculator app with fields for bill amount, tip %, and number of people. Show per-person amount with copy button."
```



Dashboard / Viewer

View, filter, and sort data from CSV, Excel, or databases

```
"Build an app that opens CSV files and shows data in a sortable table with search, filter, and basic stats."
```

TROUBLESHOOTING COMMON ISSUES

Problem	Likely Cause	Solution
"python is not recognized"	Python not in PATH	Reinstall with "Add to PATH" checked
"ModuleNotFoundError"	Missing library	Run: pip install [library-name]
App opens & closes instantly	Startup error	Run from command line to see error
.exe blocked by antivirus	False positive (common)	Add exception in antivirus settings
.exe is very large (100MB+)	Too many libraries bundled	Use a virtual environment
App can't find data files	Paths break in .exe	Ask AI for sys._MEIPASS fix



THE GOLDEN RULE

Copy the exact error message → Paste it to the AI → Ask for the complete fixed code

EXAMPLE APPS YOU CAN BUILD

Beginner

**Password
Generator**

Beginner

Unit Converter

Intermediate

Expense Tracker

Intermediate

Invoice Generator

Intermediate

File Renamer

Intermediate

Quiz / Flashcards

Intermediate

CSV Data Viewer

Advanced

Markdown Notes

QUICK REFERENCE CHEAT SHEET

ESSENTIAL COMMANDS

```
python my_app.py
```

Run your app

```
pip install [pkg]
```

Install a library

```
pip install pyinstaller
```

Install packager

```
pyinstaller --onefile  
--windowed app.py
```

Create .exe

AI PROMPTING TIPS



Be specific about data fields and features



Always include technical requirements



Ask for the COMPLETE code, not just changes



Iterate step by step — basic version first



Share exact error messages with the AI



Test as .py before packaging to .exe



YOU'VE GOT THIS!

The AI does the coding.

You do the thinking.

Describe clearly • Test often • Don't be afraid to ask for changes